Sanctions Committee proposing the listing of Masood Azhar, Azam Cheema (LeT) and Abdul Rehman Makki (JuD). [3] India had consulted the Americans beforehand. India reached out to the other Permanent Members, China included, in New York immediately after the proposal was made. It is usual practice for the committee to deliberate on the proposal and, after examining the supporting documentation, any member may place a 'hold' on the listing request. This is normal procedure to allow for committee members to seek additional information or to clarify doubts. Russia, Great Britain and China placed the Indian request on hold in April 2009.

The Chinese wanted more information about the nationality of the three individuals. The British wished to know whether Masood Azhar was still associated with the JeM, because this organization itself had undergone many name changes. Additional explanations were offered. Russia lifted its 'hold' in May; and Britain in June. Only China maintained its hold through the year 2009. China was probably hoping that the Indian request would simply melt away without them having to take a clear-cut position. However, when in late 2010, India reaffirmed to the 1267 Sanctions Committee of its interest in pursuing the listing of Masood Azhar, China averred that it was not in a position to accede to the request. This is called a 'block', and since the working procedures of the committee state that it operates on the basis of 'consensus', the committee informed the Government of India that it could not agree to the proposal for the listing of Masood Azhar.

This first attempt in 2009–2010 revealed the complex workings of multilateral diplomacy. Although the 1267 Committee has fifteen Member-States, in reality the five Permanent Members usually settle all matters amongst themselves, and without that, any consensus is well-nigh impossible. Most non-permanent members simply do not have